

Bright Bonds Handbook:

Program Overview:

Bright Bonds is a volunteer-based program in SWFL that connects high school students with nursing home residents for companionship through in-person visits and messages sent securely through our website.

Guidelines for Participation:

For Students:

- **Respect and kindness:** Treat all seniors with patience and empathy.
- **Commitment:** Attend scheduled visits and maintain regular communication.
- **Privacy:** Do not ask for or share personal contact information (home address, phone number, etc.).
- **Safety:** Follow all nursing home rules and remain in designated areas.
- **Professionalism:** Dress appropriately and engage in meaningful conversations.
- **Appropriate topics:** Avoid sensitive topics (politics, religion, etc.) unless initiated by the senior.
- **Supervision:** Always follow the facility's guidelines regarding staff supervision.
- **Open to all high school students:** Students from any school are welcome to participate in the program. However, participants are responsible for providing their own transportation to and from the nursing home for in-person visits.

For Seniors/Staff

- **Encouragement:** Help residents feel comfortable with student interactions.
- **Supervision:** Ensure that visits occur in safe, designated areas.
- **Communication support:** Assist residents with messages if needed.
- **Feedback:** Share any concerns or suggestions to improve the program.

Communication/Scheduling:

- **Emails:** All electronic communication should go through the website.
- **Visits:** Must be scheduled using the program's calendar tool and approved by nursing home staff.

Code of Conduct and Safety Measures:

- No inappropriate language, gestures, or behaviors.
- No requests for money, gifts, or personal favors.
- If any concerns arise, report them to program organizers immediately.

Volunteer Hours:

- Students will receive service hours for in-person visits (tracked by the nursing home staff and MobileServe app).

How to Report Issues:

- If any issues arise (inappropriate behavior, safety concerns, scheduling problems), contact the program coordinator at Savannah.Emrich@bvhs.org or DM our instagram at brightbonds_swfl.